

PARONYMS & HOMONYMS

The words which are different in meaning or use but are similar in form or derivations are called **Paronyms**. On the other hand **Homonyms** are similar in their sound or pronunciation but different in meaning Homonyms (different in spelling and meaning but pronounced alike.

1. Access : approach
Accession : coming to throne
Excess : more than desired

2. Accept : to take
Except : leaving out
Expect : hope

3. Alter : change
Altar : place of worship

4. Assent : agree
Ascent : climbing up

5. Adopt : take up
Adapt : adjust
Adept : expert

6. Amicable : friendly
Amiable : lovable, obliging

7. Accede : accept
Eceed : surpass
Concede : Agree

8. Alteration : change
Altercation : a noise argument

9. Apposite : contrary

10. Affect : verb
Effect : noun

11. Allusion : reference
Illusion : unreal

12. Ail : suffer
Ale : intoxicating drink

13. Apprehended : fear, perceive, arrest
Comprehend : understand

14. Admission : to get admitted, acceptance
Admittance : entry

15. Antique : of ancient times
Antic : odd, tricks

16. Alternate : by turns
Alternative : one of the two choice

17. Artful : clever
Artistic : pertaining to art

18. Artist : one who practices fine art
Artiste : performing

19. Affection : love, kindly, feeling
Affectation : unnatural behavior,
Pretence affection

20. Abstain : keep from things (eating,
drinking, voting
Refrain : keep from bad habit

21. Avenge : just punishment
Revenge : to punish out of personal
Grudge

22. Adulteration : making impure
Adultery : having extramarital
Relations

23. Aspersion : slander
Aspiration : ambition, desire

24. Avert : to check or stop
Advert : refer to

25. Birth : to be born
Berth : a seat in a train

26. Bridle : reins
Bridal : of bride

27. Barbaric : savage
Barbarous : inhuman

28. Barbarity : cruelty
Barbarism : uncivilized condition

29. Beneficial : useful
Beneficent : kind

30. Beside : by the side of
Besides : in addition to

31. Bear : tolerate, carry, give birth
Bare : naked

32. Borne : carried Born : take birth	49. Contagious : That spreads by contact Contiguous : adjacent
33. Bail : security Bole : bundle of cloth	50. Censure : blame, criticize Censor : examination of films and Plays
34. Beatific : feeling joy & peace Beatitude : state of bliss, blessedness	51. Collision : face to face Collusion : nexus
35. Caste : class of society Cast : throw Cost : price	52. Contemptible : deserving contempt Contemptuous: expressing contempt
36. Childlike : simple, innocent as a child Childish : silly	53. Considerable : large, to great extent Considerate : thoughtful of others
37. Canvass : propagate Canvas : rough cloth	54. Ceremonious : formal Ceremonial : of ceremony
38. Cite : to quote Site : place Sight : scene	55. Complaisant : pleasing, obliging Complacent : self satisfied
39. Continous : without break Continual : continuity with break	56. Conscious : aware Conscience : inner voice Consensus : general agreement Conscientious: honest, scrupulous
40. Cemetery : burial place Symmetry : quality of harmony or balance in size and design	57. Coherent : intelligible Inherent : inborn quality
41. Career : vocation, profession Carrier : that one carrier	58. Collaborate : work together Corroborate : confirm
42. Confident : certain, sure Confident : a person you trust and share your feelings and secrets with	59. Casual : occasional Causal : relating to a cause
43. Compliment : a remark of admiration Complement : that completes	60. Council : an assembly Counsel : advice
44. Cannon : big gun Canon : principle, a law	61. Councillor : member of a local Government Counseller : adviser
45. Creditable : praiseworthy Credible : believable Credulous : simple, artless	62. Corpse : dead body Corps : body of troops Carcass : dead body of animal
46. Coma : state of unconsciousness Comma : a mark of punctuation	63. Coarse : rough Course : line of action
47. Corporal : physical Corporeal : physical	64. Century : one hundred Centenary : 100 th anniversary
48. Comprehensive: exhaustive, extensive Comprehensible: understandable	65. Conservation : preservation Conservatism: the quality of not usually

	liking or trusting change, especially sudden change		or someone
66. Conform	: adhere to	83. Defy	: violate
Confirm	: ratify	Deify	: to worship
67. Capacity	: ability to contain	84. Doze	: sleep
Capability	: power of doing thing	Dose	: of medicine
68. Commonplace:	not unusual	85. Dam	: barrier built to reserve Water
Common place:	place for all	Damn	: condemn
69. Commandeer :	seize for military purpose	86. Diversion	: change in direction
Commander :	one who commands	Diversity	: variety
70. Disease	: illness	87. Envidable	: causing envy
Decease	: death	Envious	: feeling of envy
71. Deny	: action, knowledge	88. Exception	: objection
Refuse	: request, order	Exceptional	: rare
72. Duel	: fight between two persons	Exceptionable:	objectionable
Dual	: double	89. Eminent	: famous
73. Deference	: regards	Imminent	: impending
Difference	: distinction	Immanent	: present everywhere
Deferment	: postponement	90. Eligible	: fit to be chosen
74. Decent	: right and suitable	Illegible	: that cannot be read
Descent	: coming down	91. Exceedingly	: good sense
Dissent	: disagreement	Excessively	: bad sense
75. Desert	: noun (sandy land)	92. Exhausting	: tiring
Desert	: verb (leave)	Exhaustive	: detailed, comprehensive
76. Dominant	: dominating	Exhausted	: tired
Domineer	: to dominate	93. Economical	: frugal
77. Drought	: lack of rain	Economic	: pertaining to economy
Draught	: current of wind, quantity of Liquid	Economics	: a subject
78. Defective	: having defect	94. Elude	: escape
Deficient	: lacking	Allude	: refer, cite
79. Diverse	: different	95. Excite	: stir up feelings
Divers	: several	Incite	: rousing to action
80. Deduce	: infer	Insight	: ability to see the truth
Deduct	: subtract	96. Envelop	: cover, wrap
81. Deliverance	: freedom, emancipation	Envelope	: a letter cover
Delivery	: giving letter etc.	97. Expeditious	: quick, prompt
82. Decry	: criticize	Expedient	: practical, contrary to Principle
Descry	: to see or notice something	98. Esteem	: respect
		Estimate	: calculate

Estimation	:	opinion, judgement	116. Gentle	:	not harsh
99. Exposure	:	reveal, exposed to heat or Cold	Gentle	:	well mannered, of the upper class
Exposition	:	explanation	117. Gamble	:	to play for stake
100. Egotist	:	one who talks a lot of Oneself	Gambol	:	to run and jump in a playful way
Egoist	:	one who believes in self interest, proud	118. Graceful	:	moving in a smooth, relaxed, attractive way
101. Emerge	:	come out	Gracious	:	kind, merciful
Immerse	:	plunge into, absorb in	119. Gate	:	door
102. Eruption	:	bursting	Gait	:	a particular way of walking
Irruption	:	attack	120. Gravitation	:	pulling towards, attracting
103. Elemental	:	of nature, elements	Gravity	:	quality of being serious
Elementary	:	beginning, introductory	121. Hoard	:	amass, to store
104. Excursion	:	picnic	Horde	:	a gang
Incursion	:	sudden attack	122. Historic	:	likely to be famous in History
105. Entrance	:	opening, gate	Histrionic	:	art of acting
Entry	:	coming into	Historical	:	of history
106. Expensive	:	costing much money	123. Humility	:	politeness
Valuable	:	useful	Humiliation	:	insult, disgrace
107. Fatal	:	Causing death	124. Honorary	:	unpaid
Fateful	:	very significant	Honourable	:	deserving honour
Fatalist	:	believer in fate	125. Human	:	race of man
108. Forceful	:	strong and powerful	Humane	:	showing kindness, care and sympathy towards others
Forcible	:	by force, compulsion	126. Hail	:	belong to, welcome, frozen rain
109. Feign	:	pretend	Hale	:	healthy
Fain	:	gladly	127. Healthy	:	having health
110. Forgo	:	give up	Healthful	:	promoting health
Forego	:	go before	128. Hypocritical	:	guilty of hypocrisy
111. Facility	:	convenience, dexterity	Hypercritical	:	too critical
Felicity	:	apt expression, joy	129. Humanity	:	mankind, quality of being Kind
112. Facilitate	:	make easy	Humanism	:	devotion to human interest
Felicitate	:	to congratulate	130. Hollow	:	not solid, with a hole, false
113. Fair	:	a showm just, colour	Hallow	:	scared, ed
Fare	:	passage money, meal	131. Industrial	:	pertaining to industry
114. Formality	:	show ceremony	Industrious	:	hard working
Formalism	:	observance of rites			
115. Fiscal	:	of public revenue			
Financial	:	monetary			

132. Impossible : that is not possible Impassable : that cannot be passed Through	148. Observance : compliance Observation : notice
133. Ingenious : skilful, clever Ingenuous : frank, innocent	149. Official : pertaining to office Officious : living being with parts working together
134. Imaginary : fanciful, unreal Imaginative : contemplative	150. Organisation: institution Organism : living beings with parts working together Organic : natural, close to nature
135. Intelligible : understandable Intelligent : wise and sensible	151. Petrol : fuel Patrol : go round
136. Immoral : not according to morality Unmoral : non-moral, amoral	152. Pair : double of a thing Pare : trim
137. Incomparable: so good or great that nothing or no one else could achieve same standard Uncomparable: having no similarity	153. Prudent : wise, careful in duty Prudential : of prudent actions, policy
138. Invert : to put upside down Inert : passive	154. Proscription : prohibition Prescription : recommendation
139. Inept : incompetent Inapt : unsuitable	155. Putrefy : to rot Petrify : turn into stone, stun
140. Incidental : happening as natural or a part of	156. Raise : increase Raze : wipe out
141. Jealous : full of jealousy Zealous : enthusiastic	157. Reign : rule Rein : bridle of horse
142. Lightning : flash of light Lightening : make light	158. Rite : ceremony Wright : give a shape Write : compose
143. Loud : making a lot of noise Loudly : in a loud manner Aloud : audible	159. Rapt : full attentive Wrapt : lost in, absorbed
144. Learned : erudite, educated Learnt : past of learn	160. Symbol : sign, to represent something Cymbal : a musical instrument
145. Maze : winding paths Maize : a kind of corn	161. Stationary : writing material Stationary : static, fixed
146. Maritime : connected to human activity at sea Marine : related to the sea or sea Transport	162. Soar : rise, fly Sore : bitter
147. Notable : creditable Noticeable : easy to notice Notorious : unfavourable	163. Sensual : voluptuous, exciting sense Sensuous : that affect the sense
	164. Incidental : happening as natural or a part of Accidental : by chance

165. Judicious : wise, thoughtful Judicial : pertaining to judiciary	181. Pane : window glass Pain : suffering of mind or body
166. Kindly : acts, feelings Kind : tender, pitiful	182. Peel : to remove the skin Peal : a loud sound
167. Luxurious : pertaining to luxury Luxuriant : rich in growth	183. Personal : private Personnel : the people who are employed in a company, organization or one of the armed forces
168. Loathe : detest Loth : unwilling	184. Punctual : at fixed time Punctilious : very careful in duty
169. Limit : extent Limitation : shortcomings	185. Precedent : previous examples President : head of institution
170. Literal : expressed in words Literacy : of literature	186. Physique : physical health Physic : medicine Physics : a subject
171. Memorable : worthy of remembering Memorial : statue or anything in the memory of Immemorial : existing or traditional for an extremely long time	187. Prey : hunt and kill Pray : offer prayer
172. Mementary : short lived Momentous : very important	188. Proceed : to move forward Precede : to be or go before someone or something
173. Morale : The state of spirit, Confidence Moral : sense of right and wrong, Lesson	189. Politic : prudent, wise Political : of politics
174. Manifest : obvious, evident Manifestation: act or desire that makes Obvious	190. Righteous : just, truthful Rightful : having a just and fair claim according to the law
175. Negligible : unimportant Negligent : careless in duty Neglectful : careless	191. Rout : to defeat an enemy completely and force them to run away Route : Path
176. Providential : divine Provident : frugal, thrifty Providence : divine force	192. Respective : belonging to each Respectable : enjoying respect Respectful : showing respect
177. Practical : not theoretical Practicable : capable of being practiced	193. Recourse : means of action Resource : mean, raw material
178. Proscribe : ban, prohibit Prescribe : recommend, advise	194. Suspect : to think to be true Doubt : to think to be untrue
179. Popular : admirable Populous : thickly populated	195. Sociable : fond of mixing with people Social : pertaining to society
180. Pale : bloodless, yellowish Pail : container	196. Spacious : having large space

Specious : seeming to be right or true, but really wrong or false

197. Spiritual : opposed to material, of Spirit

Spirituos : containing intoxicating drink

198. Stimulant : opposed to material, of

Stimulus : Spirit incentive

199. Special : specific
Especial : to a great degree

200. Storey : upper part of a building
Story : tale

CDS PYQ

Directions: In the following questions a pair of similar sounding words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning of both the words and mark your response.

1. 'Perspicacity' and 'Perspicuity'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Perspicacity means ability to discern and Perspicuity means lucidity of expression
- (b) Perspicacity means lucidity of expression and Perspicuity means ability to discern
- (c) Perspicacity means tenacity and Perspicuity means lucidity of expression.
- (d) Perspicacity means ability to discern and Perspicuity means tenacity

2. 'Complaisant' and 'Complacent'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Complaisant means overconfident and Complacent means in the same place
- (b) Complaisant means eager to please and Complacent means overconfident
- (c) Complaisant means eager to please and Complacent means in the same place.
- (d) Complaisant means overconfident and Complacent means eager to please

3. 'Compliment' and 'Complement'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Compliment means to enhance and Complement means to praise
- (b) Compliment means to go well and Complement means to praise
- (c) Compliment means to praise and Complement means to go well with
- (d) Compliment means to enhance and Complement means to go well with

4. 'Deify' and 'Defy'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) To deify means to confer upon one the status of God and to defy means to oppose
- (b) To deify means to confer upon one the status of God and to defy means to deny
- (c) To deify means to oppose and to defy means to confer upon one the status of God
- (d) To deify means to oppose and to defy means to deny

5. 'Evoke' and 'Invoke'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Evoke means to elicit a response and Invoke means to provoke
- (b) Evoke means to call upon through an appeal and Invoke means to elicit a response
- (c) Evoke means to provoke and Invoke means to call upon through an appeal
- (d) Evoke means to elicit a response and Invoke means to call upon through an appeal

6. 'Sympathy' and 'Empathy'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Sympathy means sharing another's feelings and Empathy means understanding another's feelings
- (b) Sympathy means expressing another's feelings and Empathy means sharing another's feelings.
- (c) Sympathy means pitying another's feelings and Empathy means emphasising another's feelings
- (d) Sympathy means emphasizing another's feelings and Empathy means sharing pitying another's feelings.

7. 'Accept' and 'Except'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Accept mean to exclude and Except means to agree
- (b) Accept mean to agree and Except means to extend
- (c) Accept mean to agree and Except means to exclude
- (d) Accept mean to extend and Except means to agree

8. 'Reward' and 'Award'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Reward is compensation for effort and Award is prize for recognition
- (b) Reward is prize for recognition and Award is compensation for effort
- (c) Reward is prize for recognition and Award is gift from someone
- (d) Reward is gift from someone and Award is compensation for effort

9. 'Emigrate' and 'Immigrate'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Emigrate means to illegally go to another country and Immigrate means to arrive at another country
- (b) Emigrate means to arrive at another country and Immigrate means to leave for another country
- (c) Emigrate means to leave for another country and Immigrate means to illegally enter a country
- (d) Emigrate means to leave for another country and Immigrate means to arrive at another country

10. 'Immolate' and 'Emulate'

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Immolate means to sacrifice and Emulate means to follow someone out of admiration
- (b) Immolate means to burn and Emulate means to wear ornaments
- (c) Immolate means to burn and Emulate means to simulate
- (d) Immolate means to destroy and Emulate means to imitate

Directions: (FOR NEXT 10)

In the following questions a pair of similar sounding words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning of both the words and mark your response.

[CDS 2024 (I)]

11. 'Compliment' and 'Complement'

- (a) Compliment means to synthesise and complement means to praise
- (b) Compliment means to go well and complement means to praise
- (c) Compliment means to praise and complement means to blend well with
- (d) Compliment means to blend well with and complement means to praise

12. 'Deify' and 'Defy'

- (a) Deify means to confer upon one of the status of god and defy means to oppose
- (b) Deify means to oppose and defy means to confer upon one the status of god
- (c) Deify means to define and defy means to oppose
- (d) Deify means to deny and defy means to oppose

13. 'Stationery' and 'Stationary'

- (a) Stationary means standing still and stationery means immobile
- (b) Stationary means writing and office material and stationary means in station
- (c) Stationary means writing and office material and stationary means immobile
- (d) Stationary means standing still and stationery means writing and office material

14. 'Complaisant' and 'Complacent'

- (a) Complaisant means overconfident and comp
- (c) Complaisant means confident and complaisant means to manifest universally
- (d) Compaisant means eager to please and complacent means over-confident

15. 'Enquiry' and 'Inquiry'

- (a) Enquiry means to seek information and inquiry means to investigate
- (b) Enquiry means to investigate and inquiry means to seek information
- (c) Enquiry means to seek information and inquiry means act of investiture
- (d) Enquiry means act of investiture and inquiry means to investigate

16. 'Masterful' and 'Masterly'

- (a) Masterful means imperious and masterly means autocratic
- (b) Masterful means skilful and masterly means imperious
- (c) Masterful means leader-like and masterly means skilful

(d) Masterful means imperious and masterly means highly skilful

17. 'Boarder' and 'Border'

- (a) Boarder means a food-and-lodge resident and border means boundary
- (b) Boarder means boundary and border means a food-and-lodge
- (c) Boarder means one who fits planks on the surfaces and border means boundary
- (d) Boarder means wider and border means one who fits planks on the surfaces

18. 'Concurrent' and 'Consecutive'

- (a) Concurrent means occurring at the same time and consecutive means occurring one after the other
- (b) Concurrent means occurring non-simultaneously and consecutive means occurring one after the other
- (c) Concurrent means occurring at the same time and consecutive means occurring thereafter
- (d) Concurrent means occurring thereafter and consecutive means occurring at the same time

19. 'Epitaph' and 'Epithet'

- (a) Epitaph means a tombstone and epithet means a phrase expressing an attribute
- (b) Epitaph means words written on a tombstone and epithet means a phrase expressing an attribute
- (c) Epitaph means unspoken words and epithet means a phrase expressing an attribute
- (d) Epitaph means words written on a tombstone and epithet means an epigram

20. 'Discomfort' and 'Discomfit'

- (a) discomfort means disturb and discomfit means unfit
- (b) discomfort means unease and discomfit means to embarrass
- (c) discomfort means to embarrass and discomfit means unfit
- (d) discomfort means unfit and discomfit means to make comfortable

In the following items similar sounding words are given, followed by sentences wherein in each sentence one of these words has been used, and underlined. You are required to identify those sentences in which these words have been used correctly

and mark your response in the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (I)]

21. Pare, Pair, Pear

- 1. It is important to **pare** the branches of a tree to prevent excessive growth.
- 2. The **pair** of trees looked identical from a distance.
- 3. The **pear** tree was revered by the children of the locality for the bounty it offered each year.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

22. Séance, Sconce, Scone

- 1. Those who practise spiritualism are at times seen to participate in a **séance**.
- 2. They enjoyed eating the **scone** that were served to them in the exclusive club.
- 3. The **scone** reading on the graph indicated the correct value output of the experiment.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

23. Truism, Altruism

- 1. That one has to reap what one sows is a **truism**.
- 2. The **altruism** uttered by the seer covered the higher levels of spiritual knowledge.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

24. Consequent, Consequence

- 1. **Consequent** to the decisions taken by the committee, a new set of procedures was brought into force.
- 2. The past is of little **consequence** when one is willing to bravely face the challenges of the future.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

25. Seize, Cease, Crease

- 1. The customs department decided to **seize** the consignment of contraband goods.
- 2. To improve relations, the two parties decided that the hostilities between them should **cease**.

3. Military personnel are required to be attired in trousers with a knife-edge-like **crease**.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Direction for next 5 : In the following items, a pair of words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning and grammatical parts of both the words and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (I)]

26. Elicit and Illicit:

- (a) Elicit is a verb meaning forbidden by law. Illicit is an adjective meaning draw a reaction from someone.
(b) Elicit is an adverb meaning to draw a reaction from someone. Illicit is a determiner meaning forbidden by law.
(c) Elicit is a verb meaning forbidden by law. Illicit is a determiner meaning to draw a reaction from someone.
(d) Elicit is a verb meaning to draw a reaction from someone. Illicit is an adjective meaning forbidden by law.

27. Ensure and Insure:

- (a) Ensure is a transitive verb meaning to make something certain. Insure is a transitive verb meaning to make certain by taking necessary precaution.
(b) Ensure is a determiner meaning to make certain by taking necessary precaution. Insure is a determiner to make something certain.
(c) Ensure is a determiner meaning to make certain by taking necessary precaution. Insure is a conjunction to make something certain.
(d) Ensure is an adjective meaning to make certain by taking necessary precaution. Insure is a conjunction to make something certain.

28. Imitated and Intimated:

- (a) Imitate is a pronoun meaning take or follow as a model. Intimate is a noun meaning closely acquainted.
(b) Imitate is an adjective meaning closely acquainted. Intimate is a verb meaning take or follow as a model.

(c) Imitate is an interjection meaning take or follow as a model. Intimate is an adverb meaning closely acquainted.

(d) Imitate is a verb meaning take or follow as a model. Intimate is an adjective meaning closely acquainted.

29. Compare and Compeer:

- (a) Compare is an adjective and it means to estimate or measure something. Compeer is a determiner and it refers to the person who introduces the performers.
(b) Compare is a verb and it means to estimate or measure something. Compeer is a noun and it refers to the person who introduces the performers.
(c) Compare is a verb and it refers to the person who introduces the performers. Compeer is a noun and it means to estimate or measure something.
(d) Compare is a conjunction and it means to estimate or measure something. Compeer is an auxiliary verb and it refers to the person who introduces the performers.

30. Precept and Percept:

- (a) Precept is a verb and it means a general rule intended to regulate behaviour. Percept is an adjective and it means an object of perception.
(b) Precept is a pronoun and it means a general rule intended to regulate behaviour. Percept is an adjective and it means an object of perception.
(c) Precept is a noun and it means a general rule intended to regulate behaviour. Percept is a noun and it means an object of perception.
(d) Precept is a noun and it means an object of perception. Percept is a noun and it means a general rule intended to regulate behaviour.

Direction for next 5 : In the following items similar sounding words are given, followed by sentences wherein in each sentence one of these words has been used, and underlined. You are required to identify those sentences in which these words have been used correctly and mark your response in the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (II)]

31. Dairy, Dreary, Diary

1. She quietly stored all her sacred memories in her private dairy
2. The proceedings of the meeting went on and on and were quite dreary.

3. They always bought their milk products from the local diary.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

32. Braid, Beard, Brood

1. The engineers were asked to braid the river by converting it into a single body with the aid of an artificial dam.

2. Wise men, they say, often sport a beard

3. Among certain avian species the males are known to brood the eggs laid by females.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

33. Lesion, Legion, Lesson

1. The scan of the affected area indicated the presence of a life-threatening lesion.

2. He had a legion of followers who hung to his every word.

3. It is important to lesson the burden of others as we venture through life.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

34. Depose, Deplore, Deport

1. The director asked the actor to depose himself and instead act naturally.

2. The people are enthusiastically declaring that they deplore the salutary impact of the decisions taken by the administration.

3. Under extreme circumstances, the government can deport someone from a country.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 3 only

35. Bate, Bait, Bade

1. Those who had gathered for the unveiling were asked to bate their curiosity.

They set the bait to capture the leopard for tagging.

He reluctantly bade goodbye to his belongings.

In which of the sentences given above has/have the words been used correctly?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only (d) 2 only

Direction for next 5 : In the following items, a pair of words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning and grammatical parts of both the words and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (II)]

36. Lose and Loose

(a) Lose is a verb meaning to misplace and loose is an adjective meaning slack or movable.

(b) Lose is an adjective meaning slack or movable and loose is a verb meaning to misplace.

(c) Lose is an adjective meaning to misplace and loose is a verb meaning slack or movable.

(d) Lose is a verb meaning slack or movable and loose is an adjective meaning to misplace.

37. Anyway and Any way

(a) Anyway is an adverb meaning any manner or method. Any way is a phrase meaning regardless.

(b) Anyway is a phrase meaning any manner or method. Any way is an adverb meaning regardless.

(c) Anyway is an adverb meaning regardless. Any way is a phrase meaning any manner or method.

(d) Anyway is a phrase meaning regardless. Any way is an adverb meaning any manner or method.

38. Allusion and Illusion

(a) Allusion is a noun that is an implied reference to something. Illusion is a noun that refers to a false idea.

(b) Illusion is a noun that is an implied reference to something. Allusion is a noun that refers to a false idea.

(c) Allusion is a verb that refers to an implied reference to something. Illusion is a verb that refers to a false idea.

(d) Illusion is an adverb that refers to an implied reference to something. Allusion is an adjective that refers to a false idea.

39. Appraise and Apprise

(a) Appraise is a verb meaning to inform about something. Apprise is a verb meaning to examine and form an opinion about something.

(b) Appraise is a verb meaning to examine and form an opinion about something.

Apprise is a verb meaning to inform about something.

(c) Appraise is a noun meaning to inform about something. Apprise is a noun meaning to examine and form an opinion about something.

(d) Appraise is an adverb meaning to examine and form an opinion about something. Apprise is a verb meaning to inform about something.

40. Climactic and Climatic

(a) Climactic is an adverb meaning moment of heightened excitement. Climatic is an adverb meaning climate of a particular area.

(b) Climatic is an adjective meaning climate of a particular area. Climactic is an adjective meaning moment of heightened excitement.

(c) Climactic is a verb meaning moment of heightened excitement. Climatic is a verb meaning climate of a particular area.

(d) Climactic is an adjective meaning moment of heightened excitement. Climatic is an adjective meaning climate of a particular area.

ANSWER KEY

1.	a	2.	b	3.	c	4.	b	5.	c	6.	c	7.	c	8.	b	9.	d	10.	c
11.	c	12.	a	13.	c	14.	d	15.	a	16.	d	17.	a	18.	a	19.	b	20.	b
21.	d	22.	a	23.	a	24.	c	25.	d	26.	d	27.	a	28.	d	29.	b	30.	c
31.	b	32.	c	33.	b	34.	d	35.	a	36.	a	37.	c	38.	a	39.	b	40.	d

NDA PYQ

Directions: In the following questions a pair of **similar sounding words** is provided. You are required to select the options that most appropriately describes the meaning of both the words and mark your response accordingly.

[NDA-2023(2)]

1. 'Principal' and 'Principle'

- (a)'Principal' means belief system, and 'principle' means head of an educational institution
- (b)'Principal' means head of an educational institution, and 'principle' means original sum on which interest is charged
- (c)'Principle' means moral rule, and 'principal' means head of an educational institution.
- (d)'Principal' means original sum on which interest is charged, and 'principle' means head of an educational institution

2. 'Plane and Plain'

- (a)'Plane' means a flat surface, and 'plain' means something that flies.
- (b)'Plane' means the flat surface, and 'plain' means not elaborate.
- (c)'Plane' means something that flies, and 'plain' means flat surface.
- (d)'Plane' means not elaborate, and 'plain' means flat surface.

3. 'Pail' and 'Pale':

- (a)'Pale' means inferior or unimpressive, and 'pail' means faded.
- (b)'Pale' means faded or light in shade, and 'pail' means inferior or unimpressive.
- (c)'Pale' means faded or light in shade, and 'pail' means a bucket.
- (d)'Pale' means a bucket, and 'pail' means inferior or unimpressive.

4. 'Metal' and 'Mettle'

- (a)'Metal' is a hard shiny material that is a good conductor, and 'mettle' means malleable metal.
- (b)'Metal' is a hard shiny material that is a good conductor, and 'mettle' means metallic substance.
- (c)'Metal' means mental resilience, and 'mettle' is a hard shiny material that is a good conductor.

(d)'Metal' is a hard shiny material that is a good conductor, and 'mettle' means mental resilience.

5. 'Hail' and 'Hale':

- (a)'Hail' means pellets of frozen rain, and 'hale' means wind storm
- (b)'Hail' means pellets of frozen rain, and 'hale' means strong and healthy
- (c)'Hail' means pellets of frozen rain, and 'hale' means to greet with enthusiastic approval.
- (d)'Hail' means strong and healthy, and 'hale' means pellets of frozen.

6. 'Conscious' and 'Conscience'

- (a)'Conscious' means sense of right and wrong, and 'conscience' means awareness about something.
- (b)'Conscious' means alert, and 'conscience' means presence of mind.
- (c)'Conscious' means intent, and 'conscience' means unprincipled action.
- (d)'Conscious' means aware, and 'conscience' means sense of right and wrong.

7. 'Dissent' and 'Descent'

- (a)'Dissent' means having ideas different from general beliefs or official position, and 'descent' means movement towards a lower place
- (b)'Dissent' means having ideas different from general beliefs or official position, and 'descent' means being of acceptable standard.
- (c)'Dissent' means being of acceptable standard, and 'descent' means ideas movement towards lower place.
- (d)'Dissent' means being of acceptable standard, and 'descent' means ideas different from general beliefs or official position.

8. 'Devise' and 'Device'

- (a)'Device' means to determine, and 'devise' means a piece of equipment meant for accomplishing a specific task.
- (b)'Device' means finding a new way to do something, and 'devise' means to determine.
- (c)'Device' means a piece of equipment meant for accomplishing a specific task,

and 'device' means finding a new way to do something.

(d)'Device' means finding a new way to do something, and 'devise' means a piece of equipment meant for accomplishing a specific task.

9. 'Discrete' and 'Discreet'

(a)'Discrete' means separate and distinct categories of objects, and 'discreet' means misuse of authority.

(b)'Discrete' means separate and distinct categories of objects, and 'discreet' means maintaining confidentiality.

(c)'Discrete' means being careful in what one says or does, and 'discreet' means separate and distinct categories of objects.

(d)'Discrete' means misuse of authority and 'discreet' means being careful in what one says or does.

10. 'Eminent' and 'Imminent'

(a)'Eminent' means important and famous, and 'imminent' means something about to happen.

(b)'Eminent' means something unpleasant about to happen, and 'imminent' means important and famous person

(c)'Eminent' means important and famous person, and 'imminent' means inherent or existing within

(d)'Eminent' means inherent or existing within, and 'imminent' means something about to happen.

Directions: In the following items, a pair of words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning of both the words and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[NDA-2025(1)]

11. 'Confident' and 'Confidant'

(a) Confident means certain and confidant means close friend

(b) Confidant means certain and confident means close friend

(c) Confident means belief and confidant means an emissary

(d) Confident means assurance and confidant means intimate person

12. 'Broke' and 'Brook'

(a) Broke means abundance and brook means a flowing water body

(b) Broke means bankrupt and brook means a stream

(c) Broke means fractured and brook means nonsense

(d) Broke means negotiate and brook means a stream

13. 'Accept' and 'Except'

(a) Accept means apart from and except means recognize

(b) Accept means recognise and except means include

(c) Accept means consent and except means apart from

(d) Accept means allude and except means apart from

14. 'Accord' and 'Accrued'

(a) Accord means collected and accrued means agreement

(b) Accord means agreement and accrued means arrived

(c) Accord means accepted and accrued means received

(d) Accord means agreement and accrued means accumulated

15. 'Guarantee' and 'Warranty'

(a) Guarantee is an agreement and warranty is a service contract

(b) Guarantee is a business agreement and warranty is a service contract

(c) Guarantee is a promise and warranty is a service contract

(d) Guarantee is acceptance and warranty is a service contract

Directions: In the following items, a pair of words is provided. You are required to select the option that most appropriately describes the meaning of both the words and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[NDA-2025(2)]

16. 'Seldom' and 'Often'

(a) Seldom means hardly ever and often means time and again

(b) Seldom means time and again and often means hardly ever

(c) Seldom means never and often means not at all

(d) Seldom means frequently and often means time and again

17. 'Overview' and 'Review'

(a) Overview means assessment and review means general idea

(b) Overview means general idea and review means assessment

(c) Overview means general analysis and review means go through

(d) Overview means summary and review means evaluation

18. 'Overcome' and 'Succeed'

- (a) Overcome means triumph over and succeed means to achieve something
- (b) Overcome means achieve something and succeed means to triumph over
- (c) Overcome means to be successful and succeed means to achieve something
- (d) Overcome means winning and succeed means to rise above

19. 'Embed' and 'Imbue'

- (a) Embed means instil and imbue means implant
- (b) Embed means implant and imbue means instil

(c) Embed means accept and imbue means detest

(d) Embed means include and imbue means accept

20. 'Emancipate' and 'Empower'

- (a) Emancipate means authorize and empower means liberate
- (b) Emancipate means liberate and empower means authorise
- (c) Emancipate means liberal and empower means authorisation
- (d) Emancipate means freedom and empower means encounter

ANSWER KEY

1.	c	2.	b	3.	c	4.	d	5.	b	6.	b	7.	a	8.	c	9.	b	10.	a
11.	d	12.	b	13.	c	14.	d	15.	c	16.	a	17.	b	18.	a	19.	b	20.	b